

ATTRACTION: Ashokan Pillar, Lauria

ALTERNATIVE NAMES:

Lauria Nandangarh, Nandangarh Stupa

LOCATION:

Lauria Nandangarh

DISTRICT / REGION:

West Champaran

CATEGORY:

Historical Site

OVERVIEW:

The Ashokan Pillar in Lauria Nandangarh, West Champaran, is a significant archaeological and historical site situated near the banks of the Burhi Gandak River. The village draws its name from the pillar ('laur') of Ashoka and the nearby Nandangarh stupa mound. The site features an ancient Ashokan pillar standing tall alongside 15 ancient stupa mounds dating back to the 3rd century BCE, making it an important destination for exploring India's ancient history.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION:

Lauria Nandangarh is renowned for its historic Ashokan Pillar and the impressive Nandangarh stupa. Situated near the banks of the Burhi Gandak River, the site features a well-preserved pillar erected by Emperor Ashoka. The nearby Nandangarh stupa dates back to the 3rd century BCE. It is characterized by 15 stupa mounds arranged in three distinct rows. Each row extends upwards of 600 meters. The first row begins near the Ashokan pillar and extends from East to West, while the other two rows are positioned at right angles to it, running parallel to each other.

HISTORICAL OR CULTURAL SIGNIFICANCE:

The site is of immense historical and archaeological importance due to the presence of the Ashokan Pillar and the ancient stupa mounds. The Nandangarh stupa, dating back to the 3rd century BCE, reflects the architectural and religious landscape of ancient India during the Mauryan period. The village's name itself is derived from the 'laur' (pillar) and the stupa mound, signifying the lasting legacy of Emperor Ashoka's reign in the region.

LEGENDS, STORIES, OR TRADITIONS:

Not Mentioned

KEY HIGHLIGHTS:

- Ancient Ashokan Pillar ('laur') standing in the village.
- Nandangarh Stupa dating back to the 3rd century BCE.
- 15 Stupa mounds arranged in three rows, each spanning over 600 meters.
- Located near the banks of the Burhi Gandak River.

VISITOR INFORMATION:

Best Time To Visit:

October to March

Opening Hours:

09:00 AM - 04:00 PM

Entry Fee:

Not Mentioned

Duration Recommended:

Not Mentioned

Photography:

Photography & Videography Allowed

Accessibility Information:

Not Mentioned

FACILITIES:

Parking, Restaurants, Drinking Water, Videography & Photography Allowed

TRANSPORTATION:

Nearest Airport:

Patna

Distance From Airport:

235 Kms

Nearest Railway Station:

Bettiah

Distance From Railway Station:

25 Kms

Nearest Bus Stand:

Bettiah

Distance From Bus Stand:

28 Kms

Road Connectivity:

14 Kms from Narkatiaganj and 28 Kms from Bettiah.

Nearest Tourist Information Centre:

TIC Raxaul Railway Junction (78 Kms)

Nearest Police Station:

Lauriya (03 Kms), Ph: 06253-251238

Nearest Medical Facility:

PHC, Lauriya, Ph: 06253-251030

NEARBY ATTRACTIONS:

- Valmiki Tiger Reserve
- Amavaman

FESTIVALS AND EVENTS:

Not Mentioned

LOCAL CULTURE AND EXPERIENCES:

Not Mentioned

LOCAL FOOD AND CUISINE:

Not Mentioned

SHOPPING AND SOUVENIRS:

Not Mentioned

ACCOMMODATION:

- Hotel Ridhi & Sidhi
- Hotel Kajal International
- The Triple Crown
- Hotel Supriya International

HOTELS:

- Hotel Ridhi & Sidhi, Supriya Road (Mob: 9939508666)
- Hotel Kajal International, Kamalnath Nagar
- The Triple Crown, Cinema Road (Mob: 9835923471)
- Hotel Supriya International, Kamalnath Nagar

LOCAL GUIDES:

- Avinash Kumar Verma, Mob: 9934147229
- Abhishek Kumar Verma, Mob: 9973260605

TRAVEL OPERATORS:

- Rathore Travels Agency (Taxi Operator), Mob: 9852543836

IMPORTANT FACTS:

- The Nandangarh stupa dates back to the 3rd century BCE.
- The stupa mounds are spread across three rows, each upwards of 600 m long.
- The village gets its name from the pillar ('laur').

RETRIEVAL SUMMARY:

The Ashokan Pillar in Lauria Nandangarh, West Champaran, is an important historical site featuring a monumental pillar erected by Emperor Ashoka and the 3rd-century BCE Nandangarh Stupa. Situated near the Burhi Gandak River, the site includes 15 stupa mounds arranged in three rows. Visitors can reach the site via Patna Airport (235 kms) or Bettiah Railway Station (25 kms). Open from 09:00 AM to 04:00 PM between October and March, the site offers parking, drinking water, and allows photography. Nearby attractions include the Valmiki Tiger Reserve and Amavaman.

QUESTION-ANSWER FACTS:

Q: What is this attraction known for?

A: It is known for the ancient Ashokan Pillar and the 3rd-century BCE Nandangarh Stupa with 15 mounds.

Q: Where is it located?

A: It is located in Lauria Nandangarh, West Champaran, near the banks of the Burhi Gandak River.

Q: What are the nearby attractions?

A: Nearby attractions include Valmiki Tiger Reserve and Amavaman.

Q: How can visitors reach it?

A: The site is accessible from Bettiah Railway Station (25 Kms) and Patna Airport (235 Kms).

Q: What facilities are available?

A: Available facilities include parking, restaurants, drinking water, and permission for videography and photography.

KEYWORDS:

Ashokan Pillar, Lauria Nandangarh, West Champaran, Nandangarh Stupa, Emperor Ashoka, Burhi Gandak River, Mauryan Architecture, Bihar Tourism, Ancient Stupa Mounds, Historical Site Bihar.